SPF / DKIM / DMARC Configuration & Setup Checklist

DNS Authentication & Alignment Verification Sheet

Environment: Cloudflare DNS + Google Workspace Mailboxes - All client domains redacted

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TXT @ [SPF]
Sanitized Record Value: v=spf1 include:_spf.google.com ~all
Validation Check: Lookup count: 3/10 max - Single TXT record enforced
Auth State: SPF Aligned
PASS

TXT google._domainkey
Sanitized Record Value: v=DKIM1; k=rsa; p=MIIBIjANBgkqhkiG9w0BAQEFAAOCAQ8A...
Validation Check: 2048-bit RSA public key - Header signature verified
Auth State: DKIM Signed
PASS

TXT _dmarc
Sanitized Record Value: v=DMARC1; p=quarantine; pct=100; rua=mailto:dmarc@ops.example; adkim=s; aspf=s
Validation Check: Strict DKIM & SPF domain alignment active
Auth State: DMARC Policy
PASS

CNAME link.mail
Sanitized Record Value: track.outbound-engine.example
Validation Check: Isolated tracking subdomain with HTTPS certificate
Auth State: CNAME Active
SSL OK

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SPF Deep-Dive

One SPF record per domain, evaluated within the 10-lookup limit.

Record Consolidation
Detail: Duplicate TXT records merged
Control / Requirement: Zero permerror responses
Verification: DNS query

Include Chain
Detail: _spf.google.com / platform includes
Control / Requirement: Total lookups counted + documented
Verification: Lookup audit

Mechanism Order
Detail: ip4 entries before includes where used
Control / Requirement: No redirect loops
Verification: Syntax check

Softfail - Hardening
Detail: ~all during testing, -all at enforcement
Control / Requirement: Change logged with date
Verification: Change record

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DKIM Verification

2048-bit keys wherever the platform supports them; signatures verified from real test mail.

Key Generation
Detail: Platform-generated selector + public key TXT
Control / Requirement: 2048-bit RSA minimum
Verification: DNS published

Selector Hygiene
Detail: One active selector per service
Control / Requirement: Retired selectors removed
Verification: Register

Header Test
Detail: Authentication-Results inspected on test mail
Control / Requirement: dkim=pass with aligned domain
Verification: PASS

Rotation
Detail: Keys rotated on platform schedule
Control / Requirement: Old key revoked after overlap
Verification: Calendar

DMARC Policy & Reporting

Policy tightens in stages while aggregate reports confirm legitimate sources are aligned.

Stage 1 - Monitor
Detail: p=none with rua reporting address
Control / Requirement: 7-14 days of reports reviewed
Verification: Report log

Stage 2 - Quarantine
Detail: p=quarantine pct=100
Control / Requirement: Strict adkim/aspf alignment
Verification: Report log

Stage 3 - Reject
Detail: p=reject for full enforcement
Control / Requirement: Only after zero unexplained failures
Verification: Sign-off

Forensic Option
Detail: ruf address where legally permitted
Control / Requirement: Privacy reviewed
Verification: Optional

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Tracking Domain, MX & Postmaster Checks

Supporting records that keep tracking branded and mail flow healthy.

Custom Tracking CNAME
Detail: Branded subdomain - platform endpoint
Control / Requirement: SSL certificate active
Verification: HTTPS check

MX Integrity
Detail: Workspace MX untouched by sending setup
Control / Requirement: Inbound mail tested after changes
Verification: Test mail

Postmaster Registration
Detail: Domains verified in Google Postmaster Tools
Control / Requirement: Spam-rate dashboard reviewed weekly
Verification: Account

Blacklist Baseline
Detail: Domain + sending IPs screened
Control / Requirement: Delisting requested before warm-up if listed
Verification: Baseline log

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Verification Results & Sign-Off

Authentication is verified from live DNS responses, not screenshots. Any failed check blocks warm-up until corrected.

SPF evaluation
Tool / Method: DNS lookup count + syntax validation
Result: -10 lookups, single record, aligned
Status: PASS

DKIM signing
Tool / Method: Test mail header inspection
Result: 2048-bit signature verifies
Status: PASS

DMARC enforcement
Tool / Method: Policy record + aggregate reports
Result: p=quarantine/reject with strict alignment
Status: PASS

Sign-off
Tool / Method: Prepared by SafetyWithAthar
Result: Client domains fully redacted in this sample
Status: Rev. 0